



Tomboy

Note keeping made easy in Linux

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Tomboy is a note-keeping application, which is similar to Microsoft's OneNote that comes with the Office suite. Remember those rush hour situations of opening a text editor to type in bits of information such as phone numbers or things to do? Tomboy is an improvement over such text editors. Even though it is a small software, there are loads of features and we will be looking at how these can be used.

Tomboy comes preinstalled with Ubuntu. Later versions can also be downloaded from www.gnome.org/projects/tomboy. Once you have it up and running, creating notes is simple. Click on the Tomboy icon in the tray and choose **Create New Note**. Type in the information you want and close the window to save it.

Creating New Notebooks

Notes are easy to track, and Tomboy makes it even simpler by allowing you to create separate notebooks as a way of grouping them. For example, you can have a separate notebook for each day, or for a different topic. To create a new notebook, left click on the Tomboy icon and then on **Notebooks > New Notebook**. You can open notebooks previously created by clicking on the names in the same menu.

It is possible to move notes among notebooks. You can open a note and press the **Notebook** button on the top right and choose the notebook where you want to move it. The other way is to go to the **Search notes** window and drag and drop notes to the notebooks.

Searching Notes

Once you have started using Tomboy, you will need to access

these notes easily. The search feature can be accessed by left-clicking on the Tomboy icon in the system tray and clicking on **Search All Notes**. Type the search keywords and press **Enter** to search. You can also click on a notebook in the left pane to search only that notebook.

Creating Links To Other Notes

Links allow you to switch from one note to another. To create a link, highlight some text using the left-click and then right-click on it. Select **Link to New Note**. Enter the information into this note and close it. Clicking on the link will now take you to the new note.

Another way to create links between notes is to use the formatting methods used in Wiki. Type a keyword which you want to create a link with in this manner—**ThinkDigit**, for example. Each word should begin with an upper case and should not have any space between them. Press **Enter** and you will notice the change in formatting. Click that word to open a new note.

Exporting Notes

If you want to export notes to another computer or application, first open the note you want to export. Choose **Tools > Export to HTML**. You can also synchronise your Tomboy notes with another folder or an online service. To synchronise to a folder, right-click on the Tomboy icon and choose **Preferences > Synchronization tab**. Use the dropdown menu and select **Local Folder**. Single notes can be synchronised by choosing **Tools > Synchronize Notes**.

For WebDAV synchronisation, you first need to find a service. Once you have your login information, go to the

Synchronization tab in the **Preferences** window again. Choose **WebDAV** from the dropdown and enter the login information.

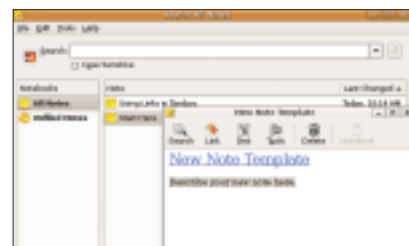
Adding And Disabling Plugins

Tomboy supports third party plugins, which can be used to add new features to the program. One can install Tomboy plugins by copying the uncompressed files to `/home/Your_userID/.tomboy/addins` folder. A list of plugins for Tomboy can be found at <http://live.gnome.org/Tomboy/PluginList>.

To access the list of plugins that come installed with Tomboy, go to the **Preferences** window and click on **Add-ins**. You may not require certain features like **WebDAV**. You can disable such add-ins by selecting them first and then clicking on **Disable**.

Customising Tomboy

Tomboy is customisable to some extent. The fonts are one such component which look good enough, but might not suite everybody. Fonts for the notes can be changed by right-clicking on the Tomboy system tray and then on **Preferences**. Click the **Use custom font** checkbox and select the font you want to use.



Creating your own notes template

Tomboy also has shortcut keys that can be used to quickly add or search for notes. These shortcut keys can be changed to easier ones. Under **Preferences**, click the **Hotkeys** tab and change them. ■

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